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Class 3 English — CA-1 (Hard) — Answer Key

Class : 3

Subject : English (Santoor)

Max Marks : 70

Duration : 2 Hr 30 Min

Syllabus: Chapters 1–3 — Colours, Badal and Moti, Best Friends

General Instructions: All questions are compulsory. For Section A, write the correct option letter.

ANSWER KEY

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (1 Mark each)

1. Which of these best explains why the story "Colours" uses two children with DIFFERENT crayon sets rather than the same set? (1 Mark)

A. To show that identical sets are more fun

B. To highlight how combining different resources creates more possibilities than having identical ones ✓

C. It is not important to the story

D. To confuse the reader

2. What can be concluded about Badal's character from BOTH his decision to bring home the puppy AND his promise to his mother? (1 Mark)

A. He is impulsive and forgetful

B. He acts kindly and also takes responsibility for his actions ✓

C. He dislikes animals

D. He never listens to his mother

3. In "Badal and Moti", what literary technique is used when the story builds worry through details like "did not come home in time"? (1 Mark)

A. Comedy

B. Suspense/tension building ✓

C. Rhyme

D. Direct instruction

4. Which statement best captures the irony (unexpected twist) in "Best Friends"? (1 Mark)

A. Friends who are supposed to get along end up arguing about who is best ✓

B. The shapes never speak to each other

C. The story has no characters

D. All shapes are exactly the same

5. If Circle, Square, Triangle, and Rectangle each represent a different personality trait through their arguments, what does this technique achieve in the story? (1 Mark)

A. It makes the story boring

B. It helps young readers understand abstract ideas like pride and cooperation through relatable characters ✓

C. It has no purpose

D. It confuses the plot

6. Which of these is the most likely reason the author chose an animal (Moti) rather than a human friend to show loyalty to Badal? (1 Mark)

A. Animals cannot show loyalty

B. A pet's instinctive loyalty and devotion makes the message about loyalty feel pure and simple for young readers ✓

C. It was easier to draw

D. The story needed more characters

7. What underlying message do "Colours" and "Best Friends" share about resolving differences between people? (1 Mark)

A. Differences should always cause permanent conflict

B. Differences, when combined or accepted, can lead to richer outcomes than uniformity or competition ✓

C. Only one person should ever be right

D. Sharing and cooperation are unnecessary

8. How does the structure of "Badal and Moti" (calm beginning, rising tension, relieved ending) affect a reader's understanding of the story's message about loyalty? (1 Mark)

A. It makes the loyalty seem unimportant

B. It allows the reader to feel the emotional weight of loyalty being tested and proven ✓

C. It has no effect on the message

D. It confuses the reader about who the characters are

9. Which best describes the shift in the shapes' attitudes from the beginning to the end of "Best Friends"? (1 Mark)

A. From cooperation to conflict

B. From competition and pride to understanding and cooperation ✓

C. No change occurs

D. From friendship to permanent separation

SECTION B — Short Answer Questions (2 Marks each)

1. Analyse why the author of "Colours" chose to resolve the story through sharing rather than, for example, one child giving away all their crayons. (0 Marks)

► Sharing (rather than giving everything away) shows a fair, balanced solution where both children benefit and keep some ownership, teaching cooperation rather than self-sacrifice, which is a more realistic and repeatable lesson for children.

2. Explain how the setting (a rainy day, a muddy lane) contributes to the tension in "Badal and Moti". (0 Marks)
 - The rainy, muddy setting makes the danger more believable and vivid, since slippery ground naturally increases the risk of falling, and rain often creates a mood of gloom or worry, which heightens the emotional tension of the scene.
3. Critically assess whether each shape's claim to be "the best" in "Best Friends" is equally valid, and explain your reasoning. (0 Marks)
 - Each shape's claim is valid in its own way, since each highlights a genuine unique feature (roundness, equal sides, and so on); the story does not suggest any shape is objectively better, but rather that all these different qualities are equally worth appreciating.
4. Explain how the theme of "promise-keeping" connects Badal's promise to his mother with Moti's loyalty to Badal. (0 Marks)
 - Both reflect commitment and trust - Badal promises to responsibly care for Moti, and Moti in turn loyally cares for and helps Badal, showing that trust and commitment can create a cycle of mutual care between characters.
5. Discuss how a story like "Best Friends", written for young children, uses simple shapes to teach a complex idea like avoiding unnecessary conflict. (0 Marks)
 - By using simple, familiar shapes as characters, the story makes an abstract idea like avoiding conflict easy to visualise and understand, since children can picture the shapes clearly and follow their argument and resolution without needing complex human social context.
6. Evaluate the effectiveness of using a puppy (Moti) as the emotional core of "Badal and Moti" compared to if the story used only human characters. (0 Marks)
 - Using a puppy adds emotional simplicity and warmth, since animals are often seen as innocent and purely loyal without complicated motives, which makes Moti's loyalty feel more heartfelt and easy for young readers to connect with emotionally.
7. Explain how "Colours" subtly teaches problem-solving skills alongside the value of sharing. (0 Marks)
 - The children must recognise a problem (limited colours) and think of a solution (combining their crayons), which quietly teaches problem-solving and cooperation as tools to overcome a shared limitation, not just the value of kindness alone.
8. Discuss whether the resolution in "Best Friends" (helped by a star) suggests that conflicts sometimes need outside help to resolve, or if the shapes could have resolved it themselves. (0 Marks)
 - The story suggests that sometimes an outside perspective, like the star's, can help those in conflict see things more clearly, though it is also likely the shapes' own growing exhaustion with fighting made them more open to reconciling once given that nudge.
9. Explain the significance of Moti "following Badal's scent" to find him, in terms of showing a realistic vs an exaggerated form of animal loyalty. (0 Marks)
 - Dogs are known to have a strong sense of smell in real life, so this detail keeps the story grounded in a realistic ability rather than an exaggerated, magical one, making Moti's loyalty feel both touching and believable.
10. Compare how conflict is introduced in "Best Friends" (an argument) versus how danger is introduced in "Badal and Moti" (an accident), and explain which feels more sudden and why. (0 Marks)
 - The argument in "Best Friends" likely builds gradually as each shape makes its case, while Badal's fall into the pit happens suddenly and unexpectedly; the accident feels more sudden because physical danger arrives without warning, while an argument usually escalates through a back-and-forth exchange.
11. Discuss what the differing personalities of Circle, Square, Triangle, and Rectangle suggest about how the author views diversity among friends. (0 Marks)
 - The differing personalities suggest that the author views diversity positively - each shape has a distinct, valid quality, implying that friend groups are stronger and more interesting when they include different kinds of people (or shapes) rather than everyone being identical.
12. Explain how "Badal and Moti" balances a happy tone at the beginning with a tense middle and a relieved ending, and why this balance matters for young readers. (0 Marks)
 - This balance mirrors real emotional experiences - joy, worry, and relief - in a gentle and manageable way for young readers, helping them understand that difficult moments can be overcome and followed by happiness again, without the story feeling frightening for its age group.
13. Analyse why "Colours" might be placed as Chapter 1 of the textbook rather than later in the year. (0 Marks)
 - Starting with a simple, relatable lesson about sharing sets a positive tone for the school year and introduces young readers to the textbook's recurring theme of cooperation and friendship, which appears again in later chapters like "Best Friends".
14. Discuss what makes Rectangle's or Triangle's (not explicitly detailed in the extract, but implied) argument likely similar in structure to Circle's and Square's, based on the pattern in the story. (0 Marks)
 - Following the pattern set by Circle and Square, Triangle and Rectangle likely also highlight their own unique features (such as pointed corners or the ability to form strong structures) as reasons they believe they are the best, continuing the story's pattern of each shape being proud of a different quality.

SECTION C — Short Answer Questions (Explain) (3 Marks each)

1. Critically analyse how all three chapters use a "problem-resolution" structure, and explain why this structure might be effective for teaching young children moral lessons. (0 Marks)
 - All three chapters begin with a problem - limited crayons, a puppy in danger (and later Badal in danger), and an argument among shapes - and move toward a resolution through sharing, loyalty, or cooperation.
 - This clear structure of problem followed by resolution makes it easy for young readers to follow the story and understand cause and effect.
 - It also reinforces the moral lesson clearly, since children see both the negative situation and the positive way it is solved, helping them remember the lesson through the story's natural flow.

2. Evaluate whether "Best Friends" successfully teaches that differences are valuable, or if it risks suggesting that being "different" causes conflict.

Support your view with reasoning from the story. (0 Marks)

- On one hand, the story does show conflict arising specifically because each shape is different and proud of its own uniqueness, which could suggest differences cause problems.
- However, the resolution reframes this - the shapes learn to value their differences instead of competing over them, showing that the conflict was really about attitude (pride and comparison), not the differences themselves.
- Overall, the story succeeds in teaching that differences are valuable, since the final message is about appreciating uniqueness, not eliminating it.

3. Discuss the role of family and community support in "Badal and Moti" (Badal's mother, Moti) and explain how this reflects real-life support systems for children. (0 Marks)

- Badal's mother represents a caring guardian who both nurtures Badal's kindness (by allowing him to keep Moti) and actively looks for him when he is in danger, similar to how parents protect and guide children in real life.
- Moti represents a loyal companion, similar to how friends or pets can provide emotional support and even practical help during difficult times.
- Together, they reflect how a strong support system - combining family and companionship - helps individuals through both everyday life and emergencies, a message relevant beyond just the story.

4. Compare the underlying values taught in "Colours" (sharing) and "Best Friends" (valuing differences) and discuss which lesson might be more challenging for young children to fully understand, with reasoning. (0 Marks)

- "Colours" teaches sharing, a relatively concrete lesson - children can easily understand physically giving or exchanging an item like a crayon.
- "Best Friends" teaches valuing differences and moving past pride-driven arguments, which is a more abstract social-emotional lesson, since it requires understanding feelings like pride and jealousy.
- Therefore, "Best Friends" might be more challenging for young children to fully grasp, since it deals with internal attitudes rather than a simple, visible action like sharing an object.

5. Analyse how loyalty is portrayed differently in "Badal and Moti" (through action) compared to how cooperation is portrayed in "Best Friends" (through changed attitude), and explain what this suggests about different ways stories can teach values. (0 Marks)

- In "Badal and Moti", loyalty is shown through direct action - Moti physically searching for and helping rescue Badal - making the value easy to see and understand through events.
- In "Best Friends", cooperation is shown through an internal, attitude-based change - the shapes rethinking their pride and choosing to get along - which is less visible but shows emotional growth.
- This suggests that stories can teach values both through visible actions (which are easier for young readers to grasp) and through internal changes (which teach more nuanced emotional lessons), and using both types across a textbook helps develop different kinds of understanding in children.

6. Discuss how the sequencing of these three chapters (Colours, then Badal and Moti, then Best Friends) might build a progression of values for a Class 3 student across the term. (0 Marks)

- "Colours" introduces the simplest value - sharing objects - as an entry point into ideas of kindness and cooperation.
- "Badal and Moti" builds on this by introducing loyalty and responsibility, values that require ongoing commitment rather than a single act of sharing.
- "Best Friends" then introduces a more complex social lesson about resolving conflict and valuing differences, building on the earlier ideas of kindness and loyalty to address more challenging interpersonal situations, showing a thoughtful progression in emotional and moral complexity across the unit.

SECTION D — Long Answer Questions (5 Marks each)

1. Write a detailed essay analysing how "Colours", "Badal and Moti", and "Best Friends" together build a complete picture of what it means to be a good friend, using specific details and reasoning from each story. (0 Marks)

- "Colours" establishes the foundational idea that good friends share with one another, showing that generosity leads to better outcomes for everyone involved, as seen when the two children combine their crayons to make richer pictures.
- "Badal and Moti" deepens this idea by showing that being a good friend also means being loyal and responsible, demonstrated through Badal's care for Moti and Moti's devoted efforts to help Badal when he is in danger.
- "Best Friends" adds a further layer by teaching that good friends do not need to be identical or "the best" at everything - true friendship involves valuing each other's unique qualities and resolving disagreements through understanding rather than competition.
- Together, these three chapters build a complete picture of friendship: it begins with simple generosity, grows through loyalty and responsibility, and matures into an ability to appreciate differences and resolve conflicts - a well-rounded set of values appropriate for young learners to absorb across a full unit.

2. Imagine a new chapter is being added to this unit, continuing the themes of sharing, loyalty, and valuing differences. Write a short original story outline (title, characters, and a summary of what happens) that fits naturally alongside these three chapters. (0 Marks)

- This is a creative, open-ended writing task; there is no single correct answer, but strong responses should include a clear title, named characters, and a summary showing a problem and resolution.
- A strong answer would connect meaningfully to the established themes - for example, a story about two friends with different skills learning to combine their strengths (extending the sharing theme), or a story about an animal and child developing trust over time (extending the loyalty theme).
- The response should be evaluated on creativity, clarity of the story outline, and how well it connects to the moral themes already present in "Colours", "Badal and Moti", and "Best Friends".

3. Reflect on which of the three chapters (Colours, Badal and Moti, Best Friends) taught you the most important lesson, and explain your choice with detailed reasoning, including how you might apply this lesson in your own life. (0 Marks)

- This is a personal, open-ended reflective answer, and any of the three chapters can be validly chosen if well-reasoned.
- A strong answer clearly states which chapter was chosen, explains the specific lesson learnt (sharing, loyalty, or valuing differences), and gives a genuine, thoughtful example of how the student might apply this lesson in their own daily life, such as at school, at home, or with friends.
- The response should show genuine reflection and a clear connection between the story's lesson and the student's own life or values.